The **lithosphere** is the solid outer part of the Earth.

The **atmosphere** is a thin layer of gases that surrounds the Earth.

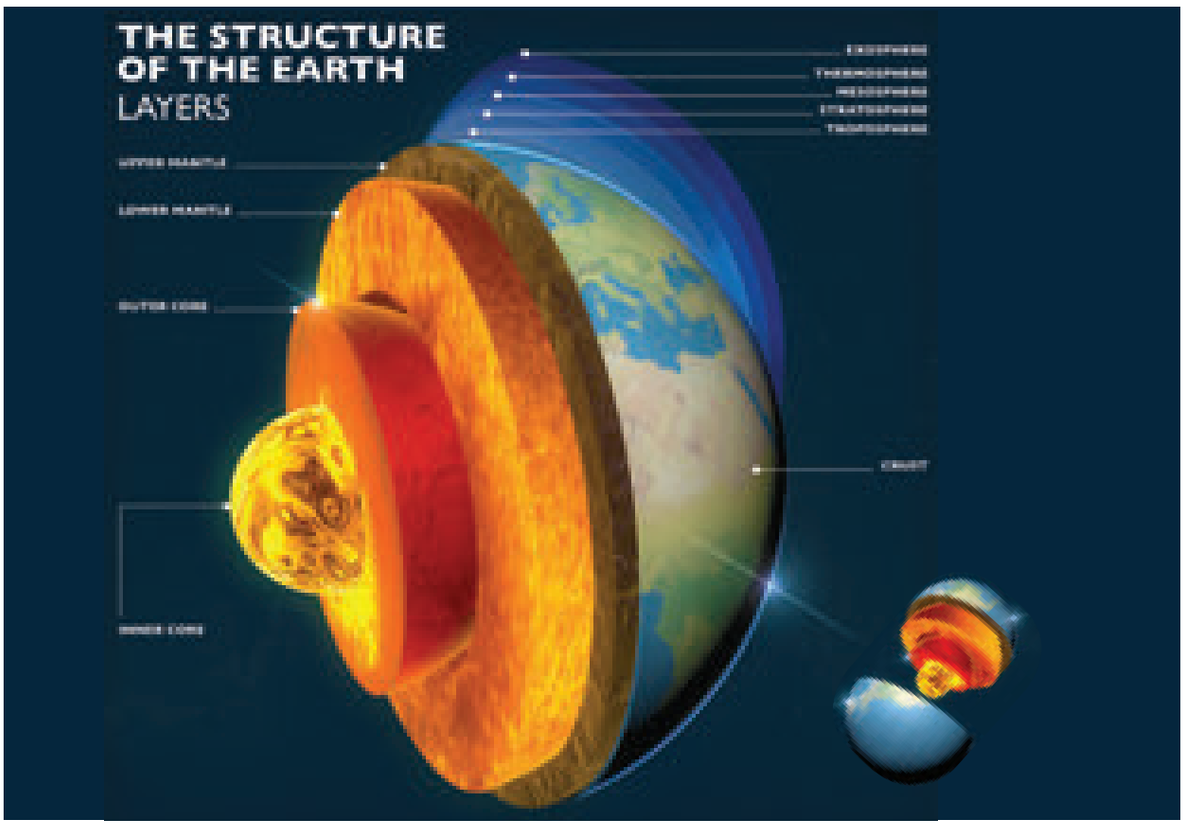
The **hydrosphere** is the watery part of the Earth's surface including oceans, rivers, lakes and water vapour

The **biosphere** is the layer of Earth where life exists.



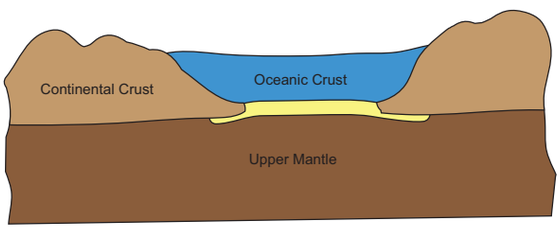
The terms **'lithosphere'** and **'crust'** are not the same. The lithosphere includes the crust and the uppermost part of the mantle.

All terrestrial planets have lithosphere. The lithospheres of Mercury, Venus, and Mars are much thicker and more rigid than that of the Earth.



Crust

Crust is the outer layer of the Earth, where we live. It is the skin of our Earth, which ranges between **5 to 30 km**. It is the solid and rigid layer of the Earth. The thickness of the crust is greater below the continents than the ocean floor. The crust is classified as **continental crust** and **oceanic crust.** The major elements of crust SIAL are Silica (**Si**) and Aluminium (**Al**) and SIMA (**Si** - Silica and **MA** - Magnesium)



Continental Crust is made up of SIAL and Oceanic Crust is made up of SIMA

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